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Curatorial Assistant II, Collections

California Academy of Sciences, Golden Gate Park, San Francisco, California, United States of America Req #88

Date Posted: Wednesday, November 8, 2023

About the Opportunity:
Reporting to the Collections Manager of Geology, the Curatorial Assistant-II performs various duties related to specimen preparation and housing as well as processing and shipping specimens being sent to other institutions. The job will also involve a considerable amount of work in the areas of data entry, and project-related curatorial tasks. The Curatorial Assistant II will also participate in ongoing operations of the department. The responsibilities for this level will include some or if not all of the duties noted below.

Organizational Culture
Join a team dedicated to the Academy's mission, vision and values! Currently, the Academy has a new strategic plan including three initiatives – Hope for Reefs, Thriving California, and Islands 2030 – that leverage biodiversity science, environmental learning, and collaborative engagement to regenerate fragile ecosystems around the world. Learn more at https://www.calacademy.org/about-us/major-initiatives.

We are committed to ensuring diversity, equity, accessibility, and inclusion are intrinsic to Academy culture and operations, from recruitment and retention to science and advocacy.

We hope you are inspired by what we do and are excited to contribute to our mission. The mission of the California Academy of Sciences is to regenerate the natural world through science, learning, and collaboration. The Academy is looking for candidates who do great work, and we know they may come from a number of different backgrounds and experiences. We encourage you to apply even if you do not believe you meet every one of the qualifications for the position.

This position is based in San Francisco, California. Please do not apply if you are not able to work onsite. This position is part of a bargaining unit represented by the Service Employees International Union Local 1021. Candidates are required to have up-to-date COVID-19 vaccination as a condition of employment, absent qualifying exemptions in accordance with applicable laws. Individuals receiving a conditional offer of employment from the California Academy of Sciences will be provided the full text of the vaccination policy. The California Academy of Sciences is committed to providing a safe and healthy workplace, to protect its employees, volunteers and guests.

About the Geology Team:
The Geological Collections of the California Academy of Sciences contain over 8 million specimens, including one of the best collections of Pacific Basin invertebrates of the Mesozoic and Cenozoic ages and fossil fish, foraminifera, and plants from California and the western U.S. The mineral collection includes a meteorite and gemstone collection and is worldwide in scope. Also housed in the department is the world's third-largest collection of both fossil and recent diatoms. These collections are actively used by researchers from around the world. The collections staff processes scores of loan requests each year, as well as host dozens of visiting researchers.

Key Responsibilities:

- Performs routine curatorial duties such as specimen preparation and integrating newly acquired specimens/objects
- Processes specimens for shipment, including properly wrapping specimens, and preparing shipping forms/labels
- Performs database entry related to specimens, label production, and data capture
- Manages project-oriented specimen processing
- May involve library work to clarify nomenclatural issues
- May train and work with departmental volunteers and students

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- May give public demonstrations, departmental tours, and answer inquiries
- Follow all Academy safety regulations
- Perform other job-related duties as assigned

Qualifications: A successful candidate will have the following

Experience and Education:

- Bachelor's degree in Geology, Biology, or a closely related field
- General knowledge of literature and curatorial procedures in Geology or Paleontology
- A minimum of 2 years experience with museum collections
- Or an equivalent combination of education and experience

Skills and Abilities:

- Good organizational and time management skills
- Specific knowledge of Geological or Paleontological collections, nomenclature, and taxonomy desirable
- Ability to understand and accurately follow detailed instructions
- Ability to responsibly handle delicate or irreplaceable specimens
- Ability to type accurately and do computer data entry
- Ability to work independently and collaboratively
- Demonstrated commitment to equity and inclusion
- Ability to perform computer data entry - depending on departments/projects % time may vary

Physical Environment:
To perform this job successfully, an individual must be able to perform each essential job duty satisfactorily. Reasonable accommodations may be made to enable qualified individuals with disabilities to perform essential job functions.

- Ability to lift 30-50 lbs.
- Ability to climb ladders 20% of the day
- Ability to reach above shoulder level for 20% of the day

In the Collections Department within the Institute for Biodiversity Science and Sustainability, the employee will be working with biological collections, some of which will be on loan from other institutions. In the past, these collections were often treated with chemicals to preserve them, to retard the growth of fungal infections or to prevent pest infestations. Although these methods are no longer in use, many of the specimens remain permanently contaminated with residues of these chemicals. While safety measures are in place to minimize the risk to employees, the applicant for this position should be aware of this potential hazard. Chemicals/chemical residues that employees may be exposed to include naphthalene, mercuric chloride, ethanol, methyl bromide, strychnine, DDT, and Vapona.

Compensation and Benefits:
Starting salary will vary based on experience, skills/knowledge set, and internal equity. The Academy offers a total compensation package that emphasizes both base salary and comprehensive benefits based on the hours per week worked.

Please scroll down to "Other details" for this position's hiring range.

Schedule: Part-Time, 20 hours per week

APPLICATION DEADLINE:
Review of applications will begin on **December 18, 2023,** and will continue until the position is filled.

APPLICATION PROCESS:
Please upload your resume and complete the brief online application.

The California Academy of Sciences will give full consideration for employment to all qualified applicants with criminal histories in a manner consistent with the requirements of the San Francisco Fair Chance Ordinance (SF Police Code, Article 49).

We are committed to ensuring that all employees and applicants shall receive equal consideration and treatment. All terms and conditions of employment, including but not limited to, recruitment, hiring, placements, transfers, promotions, compensation, benefits, terminations, training, and social and recreational programs, will be on the basis of qualifications of the individual for the positions being filled. The Academy does not discriminate against qualified applicants or employees with respect to any terms or conditions of employment on account of any characteristic protected by state or federal law or local ordinance. Read our full Equal Opportunity Statement here.

Other details

Pay Type	Hourly	Employment Indicator	Regular PT	Min Hiring Rate	$29.00	Max Hiring Rate	$32.00

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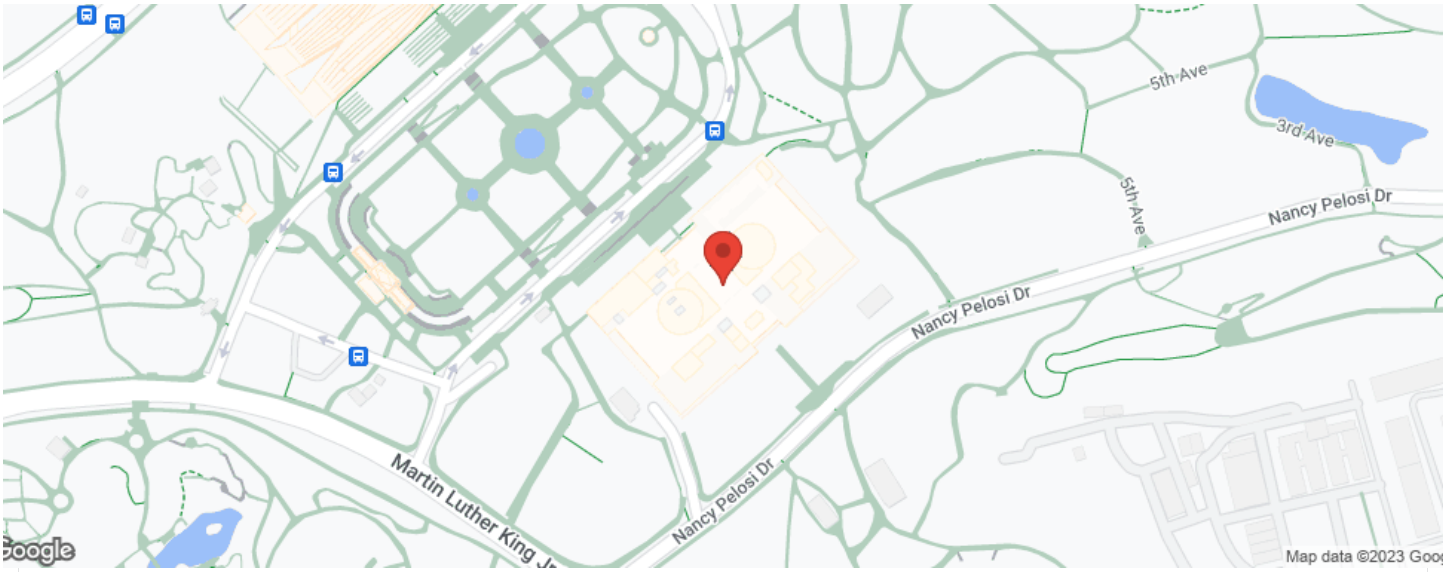

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